Report Week 5:

Building on last week's hardware and operating system verification of the **WinServer2025-Lab** virtual machine, for Week 5 I focused on user account provisioning, local security policies, power management, and baseline application deployment. First, I created a Local Standard User account named **LocalAcc** to enforce the Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP), ensuring that everyday tasks—such as web browsing, document editing, and application testing—are isolated from the primary Administrator account to prevent unauthorized system-wide changes and limit potential malware or misconfiguration risks. Next, I documented the system's Local Security Policy password configurations, verifying that password complexity requirements are **Enabled** with a **42-day** maximum password age and reversible encryption **Disabled**, while minimum password length (0 characters), password history (0 passwords remembered), and minimum password age (0 days) remain at their default baseline values. Within the **LocalAcc** profile on the C: drive, I installed and customized three core utilities: **7-Zip** (enabling "Show system menu" in the settings tab for quick access to full Windows file properties), **Mozilla Firefox** (configured as the default browser, set to a dark/black theme, and pinned to the taskbar for accessibility), and **Notepad++** (configured with a desktop shortcut and Dark Mode enabled in Preferences for improved visibility). Finally, I adjusted the VM's power settings by setting "Turn my screen off after" to **Never** to prevent display timeouts during active lab testing.